

Stakeholder Engagement Plan , Bridging the Tokenization Gap in African LLMs via SuperBPE

Stakeholder Group 1: Local Educators

Who they are: Teachers and education associations working in schools and universities across Ethiopia and other African countries. Why they are important: They are the ones who carry language and culture into classrooms, so if AI systems misrepresent local languages, it directly affects their teaching and students' learning. What matters most: They care about educational equity, accurate representation of local languages, and tools that support rather than replace their teaching role.

Potential Benefits and Risks

- **Benefits:** Better teaching resources, reduced workload, and access to culturally relevant materials.
- **Risks:** Misinterpretation of idioms, erosion of teacher authority, or exclusion of minority languages.
- **Considerations:** Respecting teachers' expertise, cultural sensitivity, and building trust in AI systems.

Engagement Method: Participatory Design Workshops

I chose Participatory Design from the Action Catalogue because it allows teachers to co-create with developers. It fits them well since they can bring real classroom examples, review tokenization outputs, and highlight misrepresentations. I would run structured workshops where teachers contribute feedback and suggest improvements. This way, the dataset reflects their lived realities and the model earns their trust.

Stakeholder Group 2: Women's Community Groups

Who they are: Local women's associations and grassroots organizations that advocate for cultural preservation and safe access to information. Why they are important: Women's voices are often excluded from technology design, yet they are central to cultural transmission and community well-being. What matters most: They value cultural preservation, safe and inclusive access to information, and protection against harmful stereotypes.

Potential Benefits and Risks

- Benefits: Empowerment through access to information, inclusion in community dialogue, and safer digital participation.
- Risks: Reinforcing stereotypes, exclusion of women's voices, or unsafe outputs that perpetuate bias.
- Considerations: Ethical inclusion of marginalized voices, accountability, and cultural respect.

Engagement Method: Distributed Dialogue Sessions

I chose Distributed Dialogue because it creates safe, small-group discussions across different communities. It suits women's groups since it decentralizes engagement and ensures diverse voices are heard. I would organize facilitated dialogues in multiple contexts, letting women share perspectives on stereotypes, safety, and representation. Their input would directly shape dataset curation and model design.

Influence on Project Design

Feedback from educators will make sure the dataset includes local language examples, idioms, and classroom practices, improving accuracy and trust. Input from women's groups will highlight gendered risks and representation issues, guiding me to avoid biased outputs. Together, these engagements will refine data sources, improve consent processes, and ensure outputs are inclusive and culturally sensitive. They will also influence evaluation criteria by embedding fairness and accountability into the model's performance.